# 📖 Books & Authors — Indian & International

**High-yield Books & Authors for SSC CGL General Awareness.** Grouped by category, with the author, the work's claim to fame, **prizes won**, and why each is remembered.

**How to use:** match book ⇄ author both ways; note Nobel/Booker/Jnanpith winners — they are the most asked.

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## 🆕 Recently in the News — Book Releases ↑ top

Auto-mined daily from GKToday (headlines only; click to read). Today's are highlighted.

| Headline | Date |
|---|---|
| *No book headlines captured yet — run after GKToday posts book news.* | |

## IN Indian Authors — Classic & Modern ↑ top

| Author | Famous Works | Prize / Importance |
|---|---|---|
| **Rabindranath Tagore** | Gitanjali, Gora, The Home and the World, Ghare-Baire | Nobel Prize in Literature 1913 (first non-European); wrote India's & Bangladesh's national anthems |
| **R.K. Narayan** | Malgudi Days, The Guide, Swami and Friends, The Man-Eater of Malgudi | Sahitya Akademi Award; created fictional town "Malgudi" |
| **Mulk Raj Anand** | Untouchable, Coolie, Two Leaves and a Bud | Pioneer of Indian English novel; social realism |
| **Munshi Premchand** | Godan, Gaban, Nirmala, Idgah | "Upanyas Samrat" (Emperor of Novels); Hindi-Urdu fiction |
| **Kalidasa** | Abhijnanasakuntalam, Meghaduta, Raghuvamsha, Kumarasambhava | Classical Sanskrit poet-dramatist; gem of Chandragupta II's court |
| **Chanakya (Kautilya)** | Arthashastra | Ancient treatise on statecraft, economics & military strategy |
| **Bankim Chandra Chatterjee** | Anandamath (source of "Vande Mataram"), Durgeshnandini | Wrote India's national song |

| Author | Famous Works | Prize / Importance |
|---|---|---|
| **Sarat Chandra Chattopadhyay** | Devdas, Parineeta, Srikanta | Most popular Bengali novelist |
| **Vikram Seth** | A Suitable Boy, The Golden Gate | Sahitya Akademi Award; one of the longest English novels |
| **Amitav Ghosh** | The Shadow Lines, The Hungry Tide, Ibis trilogy (Sea of Poppies) | Jnanpith Award 2018 (first English-language writer to win it) |

## IN Indian Writing in English — Booker & Global Honours ↑ top

| Author | Famous Work(s) | Prize won |
|---|---|---|
| **Arundhati Roy** | The God of Small Things | Booker Prize 1997 |
| **Kiran Desai** | The Inheritance of Loss | Booker Prize 2006 (youngest woman then) |
| **Aravind Adiga** | The White Tiger | Booker Prize 2008 |
| **Salman Rushdie** | Midnight's Children, The Satanic Verses, Shame | Booker 1981; "Booker of Bookers" |
| **V.S. Naipaul** | A House for Mr Biswas, A Bend in the River | Nobel 2001; Booker 1971 (Indian-origin, Trinidad) |
| **Geetanjali Shree** | Tomb of Sand (Ret Samadhi) | International Booker 2022 (first Hindi work) |
| **Jhumpa Lahiri** | Interpreter of Maladies, The Namesake | Pulitzer Prize 2000 |
| **Chetan Bhagat** | Five Point Someone, 2 States, Half Girlfriend | Best-selling popular English fiction in India |
| **Ruskin Bond** | The Blue Umbrella, The Room on the Roof, Rusty stories | Sahitya Akademi & Padma Bhushan; beloved children's author |

## 🏆 Jnanpith Award Winners (high-yield) ↑ top

| Writer | Language | Note |
|---|---|---|
| **Ashapurna Devi** | Bengali | First woman to win the Jnanpith (1976) |
| **G. Sankara Kurup** | Malayalam | First-ever Jnanpith awardee (1965) |
| **Mahasweta Devi** | Bengali | Hajar Churashir Maa; activist-writer |
| **Amitav Ghosh** | English | First English writer to win (2018) |
| **Gulzar (Sampooran Singh)** | Urdu | 2023 (announced 2024); poet-lyricist |
| **Kuvempu** | Kannada | Sri Ramayana Darshanam |
| **Mahadevi Verma** | Hindi | "Modern Meera"; Chhayavaad poet |

## 🏅 Nobel Prize in Literature — Notable Winners ↑ top

| Author | Country | Year & known for |
|---|---|---|
| **Rabindranath Tagore** | India | 1913 — Gitanjali (first Asian Nobel laureate) |
| **Ernest Hemingway** | USA | 1954 — The Old Man and the Sea |
| **Gabriel García Márquez** | Colombia | 1982 — One Hundred Years of Solitude (magic realism) |
| **Bob Dylan** | USA | 2016 — first musician to win Literature Nobel |
| **Kazuo Ishiguro** | UK (Japan-born) | 2017 — The Remains of the Day, Never Let Me Go |

| Author | Country | Year & known for |
|---|---|---|
| **Abdulrazak Gurnah** | Tanzania/UK | 2021 — Paradise; colonialism & refugees |
| **Annie Ernaux** | France | 2022 — autobiographical writing |
| **Han Kang** | South Korea | 2024 — The Vegetarian (also Int'l Booker 2016) |

##  Freedom Fighters & Their Works ↑ top

| Freedom Fighter | Books / Works | Note |
|---|---|---|
| **Mahatma Gandhi** | The Story of My Experiments with Truth (autobiography), Hind Swaraj, Key to Health; edited *Young India* & *Harijan* | Wrote mostly in Gujarati; "experiments with truth" |
| **Jawaharlal Nehru** | The Discovery of India, An Autobiography (Toward Freedom), Glimpses of World History, Letters from a Father to His Daughter | Most written in prison |
| **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** | Gita Rahasya, The Arctic Home in the Vedas, Orion; newspapers *Kesari* & *Maratha* | "Swaraj is my birthright" |
| **Lala Lajpat Rai** | Unhappy India, The Story of My Deportation, Young India, England's Debt to India | "Punjab Kesari" |
| **Bipin Chandra Pal** | The Soul of India, The New Spirit, Nationality and Empire | Part of "Lal-Bal-Pal" |
| **Subhas Chandra Bose** | The Indian Struggle, An Indian Pilgrim (autobiography) | Founded INA; "Give me blood..." |
| **Maulana Abul Kalam Azad** | India Wins Freedom, Ghubar-e-Khatir; edited *Al-Hilal* | First Education Minister; Education Day on his birthday |

| Freedom Fighter | Books / Works | Note |
|---|---|---|
| **Sarojini Naidu** | The Golden Threshold, The Bird of Time, The Broken Wing | "Nightingale of India" |
| **Bhagat Singh** | Why I Am an Atheist (essay), Jail Notebook | Revolutionary martyr |
| **Dadabhai Naoroji** | Poverty and Un-British Rule in India | "Grand Old Man of India"; Drain Theory |
| **Rajendra Prasad** | India Divided, Atmakatha (autobiography) | First President of India |
| **Sri Aurobindo** | The Life Divine, Savitri, Essays on the Gita | Revolutionary turned philosopher-yogi |
| **Swami Vivekananda** | Raja Yoga, Karma Yoga, Jnana Yoga, Bhakti Yoga | Chicago 1893 address |
| **M.N. Roy** | India in Transition, Reason, Romanticism and Revolution | Founder of Indian communism |

## 🏛 Recent Politician / Leader Books in India — & who released them ↑ top

| Book | Author | Year | Released by / Note |
|---|---|---|---|
| **The Emergency Diaries** | (on PM Modi's life, 1975–77 Emergency) | 2025 | Released by **Amit Shah** (Jun 2025), marking 50 yrs of the Emergency |
| **Apnapan: Narendra Modi Sang Mere Anubhav** | Shivraj Singh Chouhan | 2024 | His political experiences with PM Modi |
| **Exam Warriors** | Narendra Modi | 2018 | Penguin/BlueKraft; tips for students (updated ed. 2022) |
| **Atal Bihari Vajpayee – The Eternal Statesman** | Vijay Goel | 2024 | Vajpayee's birth-centenary year tribute |

| Book | Author | Year | Released by / Note |
|---|---|---|---|
| **The Sage who Reimagined Hinduism** | Dr. Shashi Tharoor | 2024 | On Sree Narayana Guru & social equality |
| **Why I Am a Hindu** | Shashi Tharoor | 2018 | Also "The Battle of Belonging" (2020), "An Era of Darkness" (2016) |
| **Chalice of Ambrosia: Ram Janmabhoomi** | Surendra Kumar Pachauri | 2024 | Ram Janmabhoomi movement |
| **Listening, Learning & Leading** | M. Venkaiah Naidu | 2024 | Ex-Vice-President's memoir |
| **Heart Lamp** | Banu Mushtaq (trans. Deepa Bhasthi) | 2025 | International Booker 2025 (Kannada stories) |
| **Indira Gandhi: A Life in Nature** | Jairam Ramesh | 2017 | On Indira's environmental legacy |
| **One Life Is Not Enough** | K. Natwar Singh | 2014 | Ex-External Affairs Minister's memoir |
| **India's Moment / many works** | Shashi Tharoor | 2023 | One of Parliament's most prolific authors |

## 🗞️ Current-Affairs Books — Recently in the News ↑ top

Merged from the repo's Current-Affairs book notes (source: GKNow). Verify dates before exam use.

| Book | Author | Theme / Released by |
|---|---|---|
| **Agatthiyar – The Unifier** | Kalaimagal Magazine | Sage Agatthiyar; North–South cultural unity |
| **India's First Olympic Gold** | K. Arumugam | India's 1928 Amsterdam hockey gold; **released by P.T. Usha** |

| Book | Author | Theme / Released by |
|---|---|---|
| **Apnapan: Narendra Modi Sang Mere Anubhav** | Shivraj Singh Chouhan | Political experiences with PM Modi |
| **Atal Bihari Vajpayee – The Eternal Statesman** | Vijay Goel | Vajpayee's legacy |
| **The Sage who Reimagined Hinduism** | Dr. Shashi Tharoor | Sree Narayana Guru & social equality |
| **Chalice of Ambrosia: Ram Janmabhoomi** | Surendra Kumar Pachauri | Ram Janmabhoomi movement |
| **The Emergency Diaries** | (on PM Modi) | PM Modi during the 1975–77 Emergency; **released by Amit Shah** |

**Quick MCQ recall:** *The Sage who Reimagined Hinduism* → Shashi Tharoor · *India's First Olympic Gold* → hockey (K. Arumugam) · *Apnapan* → Shivraj Singh Chouhan.

## 🌍 International Authors & Classics ↑ top

| Author | Famous Works | Note |
|---|---|---|
| **William Shakespeare** | Hamlet, Macbeth, Othello, Romeo & Juliet, King Lear | "Bard of Avon"; greatest English playwright |
| **Leo Tolstoy** | War and Peace, Anna Karenina | Russian literary giant |
| **Charles Dickens** | Oliver Twist, Great Expectations, A Tale of Two Cities | Victorian social novelist |
| **Jane Austen** | Pride and Prejudice, Emma, Sense and Sensibility | Classic English romance & satire |
| **George Orwell** | 1984, Animal Farm | Political dystopia & satire |
| **J.K. Rowling** | Harry Potter series | Best-selling book series in history |
| **Chinua Achebe** | Things Fall Apart | "Father of African literature" |

| Author | Famous Works | Note |
|---|---|---|
| **Paulo Coelho** | The Alchemist | One of the most translated living authors |
| **Khaled Hosseini** | The Kite Runner, A Thousand Splendid Suns | Afghan-American best-seller |
| **Fyodor Dostoevsky** | Crime and Punishment, The Brothers Karamazov, The Idiot | Russian psychological novelist |
| **Mark Twain** | The Adventures of Tom Sawyer, Huckleberry Finn | "Father of American literature" |
| **Homer** | The Iliad, The Odyssey | Ancient Greek epics |
| **Dante Alighieri** | The Divine Comedy | Italian medieval masterpiece |
| **Victor Hugo** | Les Misérables, The Hunchback of Notre-Dame | French Romantic giant |
| **Ernest Hemingway** | The Old Man and the Sea, A Farewell to Arms, For Whom the Bell Tolls | Nobel 1954 |

##  Autobiographies & Memoirs ↑ top

| Book | Author / Subject | Note |
|---|---|---|
| **The Story of My Experiments with Truth** | Mahatma Gandhi | Gandhi's autobiography (in Gujarati) |
| **Wings of Fire** | A.P.J. Abdul Kalam (with Arun Tiwari) | Missile Man's life |
| **An Autobiography (Toward Freedom)** | Jawaharlal Nehru | Written in prison |
| **The Long Walk to Freedom** | Nelson Mandela | Anti-apartheid struggle |
| **My Experiments / The Diary of a Young Girl** | Anne Frank | WWII Holocaust diary |
| **Playing It My Way** | Sachin Tendulkar | Cricketer's memoir |
| **I Am Malala** | Malala Yousafzai | Nobel Peace laureate's story |

| Book | Author / Subject | Note |
|---|---|---|
| **Becoming** | Michelle Obama | Best-selling memoir |

## 📘 Classic Books by Leaders / Statesmen ↑ top

| Book | Author | Note |
|---|---|---|
| **The Discovery of India** | Jawaharlal Nehru | Basis of the TV series "Bharat Ek Khoj" |
| **India Wins Freedom** | Maulana Abul Kalam Azad | Partition-era memoir |
| **Hind Swaraj** | Mahatma Gandhi | On self-rule |
| **Indomitable Spirit / Ignited Minds** | A.P.J. Abdul Kalam | Vision for India |
| **Exam Warriors** | Narendra Modi | For students facing exams |
| **The Test of My Life** | Yuvraj Singh | Battling cancer |

## 🔥 International Best-sellers & Popular Reads ↑ top

| Book | Author | Why popular |
|---|---|---|
| **Harry Potter (series)** | J.K. Rowling | Best-selling book series in history |
| **The Alchemist** | Paulo Coelho | Among the most-translated books ever |
| **The Kite Runner** | Khaled Hosseini | Global best-seller on Afghanistan |
| **To Kill a Mockingbird** | Harper Lee | Pulitzer 1961; racism & justice |
| **The Da Vinci Code** | Dan Brown | Blockbuster thriller |
| **The Lord of the Rings** | J.R.R. Tolkien | Defining fantasy epic |
| **The Great Gatsby** | F. Scott Fitzgerald | American classic (Jazz Age) |

| Book | Author | Why popular |
|---|---|---|
| **Pride and Prejudice** | Jane Austen | Most-loved English romance |
| **Sapiens: A Brief History of Humankind** | Yuval Noah Harari | Best-selling non-fiction; also "Homo Deus" |
| **The Diary of a Young Girl** | Anne Frank | Most-read WWII account |
| **Rich Dad Poor Dad** | Robert Kiyosaki | Best-selling personal finance |
| **Wings of Fire** | A.P.J. Abdul Kalam | India's best-loved inspirational memoir |

##  Landmark Science Books ↑ top

| Book | Author | Significance |
|---|---|---|
| **On the Origin of Species** | Charles Darwin | Theory of evolution by natural selection (1859) |
| **Philosophiæ Naturalis Principia Mathematica** | Isaac Newton | Laws of motion & universal gravitation |
| **A Brief History of Time** | Stephen Hawking | Cosmology for the public; also "The Universe in a Nutshell" |
| **The Selfish Gene** | Richard Dawkins | Gene-centred view of evolution |
| **Cosmos** | Carl Sagan | Famous popular-astronomy book/series |
| **Relativity: The Special & General Theory** | Albert Einstein | Einstein's own explanation |
| **The Double Helix** | James Watson | Discovery of DNA's structure |
| **Silent Spring** | Rachel Carson | Launched the environmental movement |
| **A Short History of Nearly Everything** | Bill Bryson | Popular survey of science |
| **Dialogue Concerning the Two Chief World Systems** | Galileo Galilei | Defended the heliocentric model |

## 🧪 Indian Scientists' Books & Popular Science ↑ top

| Book | Author | Note |
|---|---|---|
| **Wings of Fire** | A.P.J. Abdul Kalam (with Arun Tiwari) | Autobiography of the "Missile Man" |
| **Ignited Minds / India 2020** | A.P.J. Abdul Kalam | Vision for a developed India |
| **The Test of Time / Turning Points** | A.P.J. Abdul Kalam | Reflections from his Presidency |
| **What is Life? (Indian editions) / popular essays** | J.B.S. Haldane | Worked in India (ISI Kolkata) |
| **The Man Who Knew Infinity (about him)** | on Srinivasa Ramanujan | Mathematical genius; book by Robert Kanigel |
| **My Inventions / scientific papers** | Jagadish Chandra Bose | Plant response & radio waves pioneer |
| **The Grand Design (read widely in India)** | Hawking & Mlodinow | Popular among Indian aspirants |

## ⚛ Nobel Science Laureates — India-linked & Key ↑ top

| Scientist | Field & Year | Known for |
|---|---|---|
| **C.V. Raman** | Physics 1930 | Raman Effect (scattering of light); first Indian science Nobel |
| **Har Gobind Khorana** | Medicine 1968 | Genetic code & protein synthesis (India-born) |
| **Subrahmanyan Chandrasekhar** | Physics 1983 | Chandrasekhar limit (white dwarfs); Raman's nephew |
| **Venkatraman Ramakrishnan** | Chemistry 2009 | Structure of the ribosome (India-born) |
| **Albert Einstein** | Physics 1921 | Photoelectric effect (not relativity!) |

| Scientist | Field & Year | Known for |
|---|---|---|
| **Marie Curie** | Physics 1903, Chemistry 1911 | Radioactivity; only person with Nobels in two sciences |
| **Alexander Fleming** | Medicine 1945 | Discovery of Penicillin |
| **James Watson & Francis Crick** | Medicine 1962 | DNA double-helix structure |

## 🎖️ Major Literary Prizes — at a glance ↑ top

| Prize | Scope | Key facts |
|---|---|---|
| **Nobel Prize in Literature** | International | Since 1901; awarded in Stockholm, Sweden. Tagore = first Asian (1913). |
| **Booker Prize** | English-language fiction (UK) | Indians: Naipaul, Rushdie, Roy, K. Desai, Adiga |
| **International Booker** | Translated fiction | Geetanjali Shree (Tomb of Sand, 2022) — first Hindi/Indian win |
| **Jnanpith Award** | India's highest literary award | Languages in the 8th Schedule + English; since 1965 |
| **Sahitya Akademi Award** | India — 24 languages | Given by the National Academy of Letters |
| **Pulitzer Prize** | USA — journalism & letters | Jhumpa Lahiri won for fiction (2000) |
| **Vyas Samman / Saraswati Samman** | India (K.K. Birla Foundation) | For Hindi / Indian-language literary works |

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**Exam tip:** SSC most often asks *book ⇄ author* matching and "*who won which prize*". Memorise the Booker-winning Indians, Tagore's 1913 Nobel, and the Jnanpith "firsts". For current-affairs books, see 13_Books_and_Authors.md.